

Two Together

Bringing up babies

SMRITI SHARMA, 23, Project manager
ABHINAV BHASKAR, 26, Businessman



Smriti Sharma has memories of her father going the extra mile to take out time for the family despite a demanding career. She expects the same commitment for the family that she will start with Bhaskar, when the Delhi couple marries next year. "I enjoy my work but I don't think it is fair to have children and leave them to the nanny to bring up," says Sharma. It's a sentiment Bhaskar shares. "It may sound stereotypical, but I'd like Smriti to be at home to look after the children as initially a mother's role is crucial," he says. But he does not expect her to give up her career completely. She plans to continue working on freelance projects after her babies.

Out of the joint family

PRIYA SHARMA, 25, Graduate
NAVNEET GUPTA, 27, Software engineer

They met at a wedding, fell in love and decided to tie the knot. A marriage to Gupta is, "a socially acceptable way to share a life," even though they would have been happy in a live-in relationship. Despite the offer by Gupta's parents to live with them, the Delhi couple plans to rent out an apartment. Sharma says, "This way, we have space and lead a life our parents may not agree with." Their take on sex? Gupta believes in open relationships and finds the idea of a single sexual partner completely unnatural. Exactly opposite to what Sharma believes in. Both know they may get attracted to someone else, but being honest with each other will help in the long run.



Love, not arranged

Y. LALITHA, 25, PR professional
K. HEMANT, 29, Software professional



Keen to find their own partners, Lalitha from Chennai and Hemant from Hyderabad registered on a marriage portal. "It was easy to meet guys from across the country," says Lalitha, who wanted to marry within the caste and to someone who spoke her language. "I think it makes life easy if you find someone familiar with your way of life," she says. Hemant adds, "it was an ideal situation. Our family backgrounds were similar and we hit it off well." After online chats and phone calls, they spoke to their parents. "Their blessings and consent matter to us," says Lalitha.

by Deepika Khatri and Akhila Krishnamurthy

course or by the husband's exercise of his "right"—very soon after marriage. In all except a handful of Ghurye's 304 cases, the wives were housewives which meant that the present concern with the declining libido of the working wife or her presumed propensity for a fling or two outside marriage, was hardly an issue.

As with contemporary surveys, Ghurye laid much stress on "methodology". After all, it was important for him to demonstrate that his inquiry was motivated by scientific, not merely prurient, interest. Then, and now, the respondents were assured of confidentiality. One of them in fact regretted that a schedule on such "a very vital issue" was so short. Assisted by second, third-year students and friends, nearly 2,000 questionnaires were distributed to middle class men in Bombay city, resulting—after "repeated calls"—in 311 responses from Hindu males. Seven of these, Ghurye regretted, had to be rejected because the answers were defective or self-contradictory, "or because the desire of the person replying to crack jokes was apparent".

On the whole, most sex surveys nowadays seek to monitor behavioural trends from one survey to the next, or else to map a sexual geography—across the world or, as in the INDIA TODAY survey, across the metros of a large and diverse country. So it is newsworthy that Indian women have begun relishing foreplay as never before; that the French do not live up to their reputation as great lovers; or that virginity at marriage is more important in Delhi, Ludhiana and Ahmedabad